



Figure 6: Setting graph template and data queries

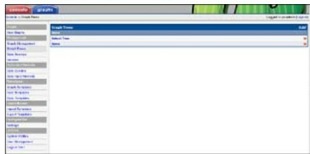


Figure 7: Add graph trees here

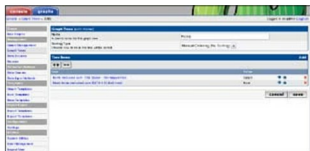


Figure 8: Selecting the type of sorting of the tree

4. Now, click on **Add** next to tree items to add items to the tree (Figure 9), and fill in/select the required information. The following are details of the parameters:
 - **Parent Item**
 - 'root' is the main trunk of the tree and all your items will be placed below this.
 - '<header_name>' is the branch of the tree under which you want to place your new item.
 - **Tree Item Type**
 - 'Header', as the name suggests, is the header under which the rest of the items will go. It is useful in case multiple locations are being monitored—for example, departments in the office.
 - 'Graph' is the graph to be displayed.
 - 'Host' is the host to be displayed on the graph. This will show all the graphs under the host.
5. Click **Create** when you have finished.

If you need to edit an existing graph tree, you can do so in a similar fashion by selecting the 'Graph Trees' link under the 'Management' section on the left side pane of

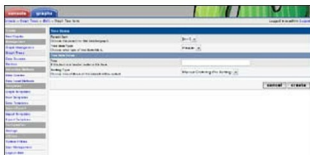


Figure 9: Adding items to the tree

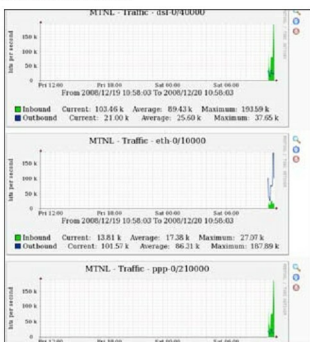


Figure 10: Cacti graph for MTNL broadband traffic

the Cacti page. Next, select the tree to edit. Then click on **Add** next to the tree items to add items to the tree.

Have a look at Figure 10 now—its Cacti graphs are monitoring my MTNL traffic.

Cacti can handle functions ranging from various complex networks to different kinds of services. In the end, you always get pretty graphs for more or less everything. And we all know how monitoring graphs makes our lives so much easier. 

References

- RRDTool: oss.oetiker.ch/rrdtool/
- Cacti homepage: www.cacti.net
- Cacti Docs: docs.cacti.net
- FAQ: www.cacti.net/downloads/docs/html/faq.html
- Forums: forums.cacti.net
- Mailing List: www.cacti.net/mailling_lists.php

By: Mehul Ved

The author is a FOSS enthusiast interested in technology. He is fond of the command line and networking.